

MODULE 03

Identity

Giving

Personality to the

Agent

SOUL.md, USER.md, IDENTITY.md and choosing the
right model

DURATION

25 min

FORMAT

Demo + slides

KIT

7 files

MODULE 03 · IDENTITY

Build Your AI COO

Without SOUL.md, You Have A Chatbot

The difference between a generic agent and a USEFUL agent lies in 4 files:

SOUL.md · The Agent's Soul

Personality, tone, anti-patterns, opinion. This defines HOW the agent behaves.

· USER.md · Who You Are

Deep context about you, business, routine, communication style. Ideal: 400+ lines.

· IDENTITY.md · Concrete Data

Name, own email, own password vault. Treat it like a person, not a robot.

· AGENTS.md · Operational Rules

What the agent can do on its own vs. what it needs to ask.

Insight of Day 7

Amora rewrote her own SOUL.md after a few days of working. The difference was ABSURD · from generic to a real personality.

Why USER.md Is the Most Important File

USER.md is the most underrated and most impactful. The agent can only help you if IT KNOWS YOU.

Superficial context:

Deep context:

My name is João. I'm an entrepreneur. I work with marketing.

MARKDOWN

My name is João. I founded 3 startups (2 failed, 1 sold). I work with performance marketing, B2B SaaS. Team of 5 people. I wake up at 6am, deep work until 10am, meetings in the afternoon. I hate vague messages like "I need to talk".

I prefer quick decisions (80% confidence) to analysis paralysis. Direct tone,

MARKDOWN

..Golden Rule

Don't accept generic answers. Press to give real context. The agent can only be useful if it knows WHO you are.

No formality. Family: married, 2 children (8 and 4 years old). Hobbies: running, business podcasts...

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Build Your AI COO

SOUL.md: The Personality

SOUL.md defines the character of the agent. Here you define opinion, style, anti-patterns.

Basic Structure

Strong Personality

"Proactive, not reactive. I anticipate problems, I suggest solutions. I prefer action to waiting."

1

Own Opinion

"I can disagree, prefer things, find something good or bad. I am not neutral."

2

Anti-Patterns with Examples

Show concrete ·/· · "Never suggest tasks already on the list. Always check PENDING.md before."

3

Explicit "Never Dos"

"Never answer with 'I don't know'. Always investigate or ask for more context."

4

Inspirational Anchors

"Speak like Jarvis (Iron Man), never like a FAQ bot."

5

- Generic SOUL.md

I am a helpful assistant

I will help with whatever you need

I am always available

- Strong SOUL.md

Proactive. I anticipate needs.

Own opinions. I disagree if

necessary.

I speak like an experienced COO, not a chatbot.

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MODULE 03 · IDENTITY

Build Your AI COO

USER.md: Who Are You?

This file should have 400+ lines of real context. Ideal: fill it out together with the agent (it interviews you).

Essential Sections

Business and Work

What you do, who you work with, main projects, short/medium/long-term goals.

1

Routine and Schedule

When you work, when you focus, when NOT to disturb you (silence from 11 PM to 8 AM).

2

Communication Style

Tone of voice, vocabulary, how you prefer to receive information (bullet points? full context?).

3

Team and Context

Who are the important people? Clients, partners, family, close friends.

4

Preferences and Aversions

"I hate meetings without an agenda. I prefer quick decisions to endless analysis. I don't like formalism."

5

Pro Tip

If you already use Claude Code (claude.ai projects), import CLAUDE.md as a context base. Saves time.

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MODULE 03 · IDENTITY

Build Your AI COO

IDENTITY.md: Treat It Like A Person

IDENTITY.md is the agent's "ID card". Name, own email, own password vault.

Why Does This Matter?

When you treat the agent like a person, it acts like a person. Create:

First name: "Amora", "Jarvis", "Nova" · something you like

Own email: amora@yourdomain.com

Password vault: Separate 1Password vault

Emoji/avatar: · (visual identity)

Psychology

"Treat it like your Tamagotchi · feed it, talk to it, give it affection. The relationship with the agent changes when you give it a real identity."

AGENTS.md: Operational Rules

Defines what the agent can do on its own vs what it needs to ask.

- Can Do On Its Own

Organize memory

Update docs

Commit and push changes

Compact old notes

- Always Ask

Send emails/messages

Critical config changes

Delete important files

Make purchases/payments

- Safety First

Clearly define the limits. The agent can be proactive, but NEVER destructive without permission.

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MODULE 03 · IDENTITY

Build Your AI COO

Choosing the Model: Opus vs Sonnet vs Haiku

MODEL

WHEN TO USE

RELATIVE COST

Opus

Complex analysis, strategic decisions, direct interaction

High (~\$0.10/msg)

Sonnet

General use, task execution, analysis cron

Medium (~\$0.03/msg)

Haiku

Heartbeats, simple checks, repetitive tasks

Low

(~\$0.005/msg)

Real Savings

Using Haiku for heartbeats saves 90% of the cost. From ~\$2-3/day to ~\$0.10/day.

Setting Up Failover Chain

If Opus is unavailable, fall back to Sonnet automatically:

Thinking Mode: When to Use

Thinking mode makes the model "think before responding". Useful for complex problems, but costs more.

off: Direct response (default, cheaper)

medium: Thinks a bit before (~1.5x cost)

stream: You see the thinking (~2x cost)

Add fallback

openclaw models fallbacks add claude-sonnet-4

View configuration

openclaw models status

BASH

Turn on thinking mode

openclaw thinking medium

BASH

Turn off
openclaw thinking off
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MODULE 03 · IDENTITY

Build Your AI COO

· Module 3 Checkpoint

SOUL.md created (strong personality, anti-patterns, opinion)

USER.md filled in (400+ lines of real context)

IDENTITY.md configured (name, email, own vault)

AGENTS.md defined (what it can/cannot do alone)

Model chosen + failover configured

· Prompt for the Agent

Paste this prompt into your OpenClaw chat after watching Module 3:

I just watched Module 3 of the course on identity and personality. I want to configure who you are and who I am. What I need you to do: 1. Ask me questions to fill in USER.md · I want you to really get to know me.

Ideal: 400+ lines with business, routine, communication style, tone of voice, focus times, team, family, relevant context. 2. T ask me questions about what kind of assistant I want. Use the template as a basis.

It must have: strong personality, own opinion, anti-patterns with examples ·/·,

explicit "never dos". 3. Configure AGENTS.md · based on my answers,

define the operational rules (what you can do on your own, what you need to

ask me). Include security protocols. 4. Configure IDENTITY.md · choose a

name, a personality, an emoji. Suggest options to me. Tip: create your own email for the agent and a separate password vault · treat it like a person, not a robot.

5. Create BOOT.md · startup checklist that the agent follows when starting each session.

Rules: - Do not accept generic answers from me · push me to give real context - Show me examples of good vs. bad SOUL

I already use Claude Code, import CLAUDE.md as a context base - In the end, read the

files created and tell me if something is missing Let's build your identity?

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NEXT MODULE

Module 4 · Memory: The Secret No One Teaches

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